

Watch your videos on the Apple TV

A no-jargon guide to playing the videos from your home server (Jellyfin) on your Apple TV — using the easiest app, or the VLC you already have. Read it when you're tired; it's meant to just work.

The 30-second mental model

Two pieces talk to each other over your home Wi-Fi:

 The server (Jellyfin)	Your own private Netflix. It runs on your home cluster and holds all your videos. You don't touch it — it just sits there serving.
 The app (on Apple TV)	The "player." It connects to the server, shows your library, and plays a video on the big screen.

That's it. The app needs to know **one address** to find the server — that's the only setup.

★ The one thing to know — your server address

`https://jellyfin.lan`

Backup, if that doesn't work: `https://192.168.5.173`. Your Apple TV must be on the **same Wi-Fi** as the server. That's the whole secret.

A The easy way: the **Swiftfin** app RECOMMENDED

Swiftfin is a **free** app made specifically for Jellyfin on Apple TV. It's the nicest experience — posters, "continue watching," the works. This is the path to try first.

- 1 On the Apple TV, open the **App Store** and search **Swiftfin**. Install it (it's free).
- 2 Open Swiftfin. It'll ask to **add a server** — choose **Add Server / Connect Manually**.
- 3 Type your address exactly: **https://jellyfin.lan** (or the backup **https://192.168.5.173**).
- 4 If it warns about a **certificate** (because it's your own private server, not a public website) — choose **Trust / Continue**. That's expected and safe on your own network.
- 5 **Log in** with your Jellyfin username and password.
- 6 Open the **Hacker News FM** library → pick a video → press play. 🎉

💡 **Infuse** is another popular Apple TV app that also works with Jellyfin — a fine alternative if you ever want to try one. But Swiftfin is free and purpose-built, so start there.

Why an "app" and not just a website?

Apple TV doesn't really do web browsers. So instead of visiting **jellyfin.lan** in a browser (which is how you'd see it on a laptop), you use an **app** that knows how to talk to Jellyfin. Same server, same videos — just a TV-friendly remote-controlled front door.

B The "I already have VLC" way

You've got **VLC** on your Apple TV and like it — great. VLC isn't a Jellyfin app, but it can still **find your server over the network** using something called **DLNA** (think: a way for media gadgets on the same Wi-Fi to discover and share with each other). One small one-time switch in Jellyfin, then VLC can browse it.

One-time: turn on DLNA in Jellyfin (from a laptop)

- 1 On a computer, go to **<https://jellyfin.lan>** and sign in.
- 2 Go to **Dashboard** → **Plugins** (or **Playback** on older versions) and enable/install **DLNA**. Save.

(If you can't find DLNA, don't sweat it — just use Swiftfin from Way A. DLNA is the only reason VLC needs this step.)

On the Apple TV, in VLC

- 1 Open **VLC**.
- 2 Go to the **Network** tab → **Local Network**.
- 3 Your **Jellyfin** server should appear in the list (that's DLNA working). Open it.
- 4 Browse into your videos and press play.

💡 Honest note: VLC will play the files, but it won't show the nice posters, descriptions, or "resume where you left off." For your AI videos with their cover art and metadata, **Swiftfin (Way A) looks much better**. Keep VLC as a handy backup.

? If it won't connect (quick fixes)

Server not found	Make sure the Apple TV is on the same Wi-Fi as the cluster. This is the #1 cause.
"jellyfin.lan" doesn't work	Type the backup address instead: https://192.168.5.173 . (The .lan name only works if your TV uses your home network's name service.)
Certificate / "not secure" warning	Expected — it's your own private server, not a public site. Choose Trust / Continue .
Wrong password	Use your Jellyfin account (the one you log into at jellyfin.lan), not your Apple ID.
New videos missing	They appear automatically, but you can force it: on a laptop at jellyfin.lan → Dashboard → Scan All Libraries.

📖 Tiny glossary

Media server	The computer program that stores your videos and serves them on demand. Yours is Jellyfin .
Client / app	The thing you watch <i>with</i> — Swiftfin or VLC on the Apple TV.
Library	A collection inside Jellyfin. Yours is " Hacker News FM ."
IP address	A device's number on your network, like a house address. Your server's is 192.168.5.173 .
LAN / Wi-Fi	Your home network. Everything here only works when devices share it.
DLNA	An older "discover media on the network" standard. It's how VLC finds Jellyfin.

🔧 **Want it even simpler?** If the address or certificate ever feels fiddly on the Apple TV, I can set up a plain, number-only address (no certificate prompt) for the server — just ask.

You've got this. Same Wi-Fi → install Swiftfin → type the address → log in → play. 💜